A Strategic CSR Framework for Advancing Cultural Sustainability in Korea–UAE Partnerships



Stakeholder prioritization for sustainable Impact

KCC UAE acts as a cultural bridge introducing Korean heritage and promoting mutual understanding between Korea and the UAE

Keep Satisfied (High Power - Low Interest)

They have high influence but less day-to-day involvement.

- Corporate & Event Partners / Sponsors
- Media & Digital Platforms





Manage Closely (High power - High Interest)

These are the MOST critical stakeholders driving the sustainability mission.

- JYP Entertainment
- UAE Ministry of Culture and Youth
- Korean Ministry of Culture, Sports & Tourism / KOFICE
- KCC UAE Leadership

한국문화원
Korean Cultural Center

KOFICE
한국국제문화교류진흥원

UNITED ARAB EMIRATES
MINISTRY OF CULTURE

JYP LEADER IN ENTERTAINMENT

Target Stakeholder's Alignment Strategies

- Sustainability-linked Sponsor Contracts
- Implementing shared Sustainability Framework & Data Reporting System
- Launch a Digital Youth Feedback loop

Monitor (Low Power - Low Interest)

- General Public /Casual Attendies
- Small commmunity groups





They do not influence sustainability, but must be monitored.

Keep Informed (High Interest - Low Power)

- Schools & Universities in UAE
- Youth Participants & Fans
- Volunteers / Instructors





They care deeply, participate actively, but lack formal power.

Power

Interest

Framework: Johnson, Scholes & Whittington — Power–Interest Matrix

CSR Activities & Long-term Sustainability

How CSR supports Sustainability ?

- In the UAE, youth empowerment programs in dance, language, and the arts foster long-term human capital and cultural literacy. (KCC UAE, 2024)
- High ESG Performance (JYP ESG Score: 93.66) lowers partnership risk and boosts credibility. ((FnNews, 2025)
- Community cultural events promote social cohesion and further the long-term cultural development objectives of the United Arab Emirates (e.g., K-City program). (Khaleej Times, 2024).

Alignment with Strategic goals

- HR: Program quality and safety are enhanced by ethical instructor training.
- Finance: Long-term sponsor relationships are drawn to companies with a strong reputation for corporate social responsibility.
- Marketing: Involving young people fosters genuine brand trust and cultural relevance.
- Management: Better governance and stakeholder alignment are ensured by cross-agency coordination.

By enhancing governance, creating community value, and coordinating initiatives with UAE cultural goals, CSR directly promotes long-term sustainability.

CSR Decoupling Analysis & Governance Solutions

Targeted Governance fix

- Accessibility Audit: Track seat limits, registrations, and participant reach to verify “accessible to everyone.” (HR + Operations)
- Two-Way Exchange Reporting: Compare Korea→UAE vs. UAE→Korea activities to validate “cultural bridge” claims. (Finance + Management)
- Program Impact KPIs: Measure attendance diversity, repeat participation, and feedback to prove real community impact. (Marketing + Program Team)

Public Claim	In Practice	Potential Gap / Decoupling Risk
KCC UAE promises commitment to cultural exchange and inclusivity (promoting Korean culture throughout UAE)	• The majority of KCC events are short-term activities that provide cultural exposure but lack long-term or ongoing development programs, such as K-pop showcases, film screenings, festivals, and seminars.	• Even though KCC UAE is committed to long-term cultural interaction, its initiatives are mostly short-term events without impact reports or verifiable assessments, indicating a gap between its symbolic claims and measurable results. • This suggests a lack of evidence for achieving its stated objectives regarding long-term cultural evolution, though it does not imply dishonesty.
KCC UAE claims to provide “a gateway to Korean culture that is accessible to everyone.”	• Actual programs often require RSVP, have limited seating, and occur mainly in Abu Dhabi, making access restricted for many UAE residents.	• The widespread promise of complete accessibility and the actual limitations of restricted seating, registration, and location-specific events diverge. In the absence of quantifiable inclusion indicators, this suggests possible symbolic accessibility claims.
KCC UAE states that it “serves as a cultural bridge, fostering mutual understanding” and “plays a pivotal role in deepening the cultural ties between Korea and the UAE” through a wide array of programs (language, arts, cuisine, crafts, Taekwondo)	• Public programs largely focus on one-way promotion of Korean culture in the UAE, with minimal evidence of two-way exchange or Emirati culture being showcased back to Korean audiences.	• Although KCC UAE claims to be a cultural ‘bridge,’ publicly available evidence shows mainly one-way cultural export (Korea → UAE) with no visible UAE→Korea programs or co-created initiatives, indicating a gap between the narrative of mutual exchange and actual practice.

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- Mitchell, R.K., Agle, B.R. & Wood, D.J. 1997, 'Toward a theory of stakeholder identification and salience: Defining the principle of who and what really counts', Academy of Management Review, vol. 22, no. 4, pp. 853–886.

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- Gulf News 2024, 'Korean Cultural Center brings traditional music performance to the UAE', Gulf News, viewed 27 November 2025, https://gulfnews.com/friday/art-people/korean-cultural-center-brings-traditional-music-performance-to-the-uae-1.1726065571627.
- Business Newse 2024, 'The vibrant spread of Korean culture in the UAE', Business Newse, viewed 27 November 2025, https://www.businessnewse.com/2024/11/21/the-vibrant-spread-of-korean-culture-in-the-uae/.

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- US Army War College 2023, Culture as National Power, War Room, viewed 27 November 2025, https://warroom.armywarcollege.edu/articles/culture-as-national-power/.

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- World Cities Culture Forum 2022, Dubai Creative Impact Report, viewed 27 November 2025, https://worldcitiesscultureforum.com/city-project/dubai-creative-impact-report/

Sustainability Ranking

- TIME Magazine 2023, World's Best Companies for Sustainable Growth, TIME, viewed 27 November 2025.

Appendix

Group Members:
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Jonathan Sunil - 8266906
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Name of the Tutor : Dr. Jaeyoung Cho

Contribution of Team Members

Pallavi Nair Sooraj Manjusree

- Arranged the final presentation and oversaw all meetings.
- Conducted studies on Triple Bottom Line application, ESG analysis, and CSR sustainability frameworks.
- Created the final slides and included appendices and references.

Jonathan Sunil

- Contributed to the Power-Interest Matrix and carried out research on stakeholder prioritisation.
- Gathered proof from the KCC UAE website and confirmed comments made in public.
- Helped in compiling gaps for CSR decoupling.

Jeeva Sanil

- Found connections between sustainability and CSR to support CSR analysis.
- Contributed to the writing of the section on management alignment, marketing, finance, and HR.
- Helped revise and proofread the content of the slides.

Pranav Suresh

- Researched UAE cultural policy frameworks and the role of KCC UAE in cultural diplomacy.
- Assisted with sourcing articles (Gulf News, Khaleej Times, BusinessNewse).
- Helped prepare data summaries for appendix slides.

Yaseen Mohammed

- Helped review event listings, RSVP data, and location distribution for “In Practice” evidence.
- Contributed to decoupling table and governance recommendations.
- Assisted in checking formatting and organizing appendix slides.

Key Information gathered

Methodology of Stakeholder Identification and priortization

Mapped the strategic objectives of:

- Korean Cultural Centre UAE → heritage promotion, cultural diplomacy
- ESG-driven content production and artist welfare at JYP Entertainment
- Examined official cultural diplomacy documents from Korea and the United Arab Emirates in order to identify key players (regulators).
- Identified community-based and educational stakeholders by analysing KCC UAE's public programs and event frameworks.
- Evaluated JYP's wellness policies, governance framework, and ESG approach to ascertain operational influence.
- Categorised young, fans, and volunteers based on international research on K-pop fan ecosystems and cultural diplomacy.
- Based on influence + engagement motive, all stakeholders were plotted into the four quadrants of the Power-Interest Matrix.

Mitchell, Agle, and Wood (1997) provided guidelines for stakeholder identification. Prior to mapping these groups into the Power–Interest Matrix, power, legitimacy, and urgency traits were used to identify which organisations qualified as salient stakeholders.

Data and Sources (All links available in References)

- Korean Cultural Center UAE – Program information & cultural mission
- UAE Ministry of Culture & Youth – Cultural cooperation strategy
- Korean Ministry of Culture, Sports & Tourism (MCST) – Hallyu global expansion guidelines
- KOFICE – International cultural exchange and partnership activities
- JYP Entertainment – ESG Strategy (“Leader of Change”), sustainability commitments
- Johnson, Scholes & Whittington (2008) – Power–Interest Matrix
- Mitchell, Agle & Wood (1997) – Stakeholder Salience Theory

Key Information gathered

Cultural Policy Alignment With UAE Vision

The expansion of cultural spaces, worldwide cultural alliances, and the development of the creative economy are the main priorities of the UAE's Ministry of Culture.

An important step towards integrating Korean culture into Dubai's creative economy environment is the projected K-City project.

Elkington's Triple Bottom Line (TBL framework)

- Social value → youth empowerment, cultural literacy
- Environmental/governance value → strong ESG practices
- Economic value → stable partnerships via credibility

John Elkington first presented the Triple Bottom Line (TBL) concept in 1997. In his 1998 essay on Environmental Quality Management, Elkington clarified the TBL framework's three pillars: People, Planet, and Profit.

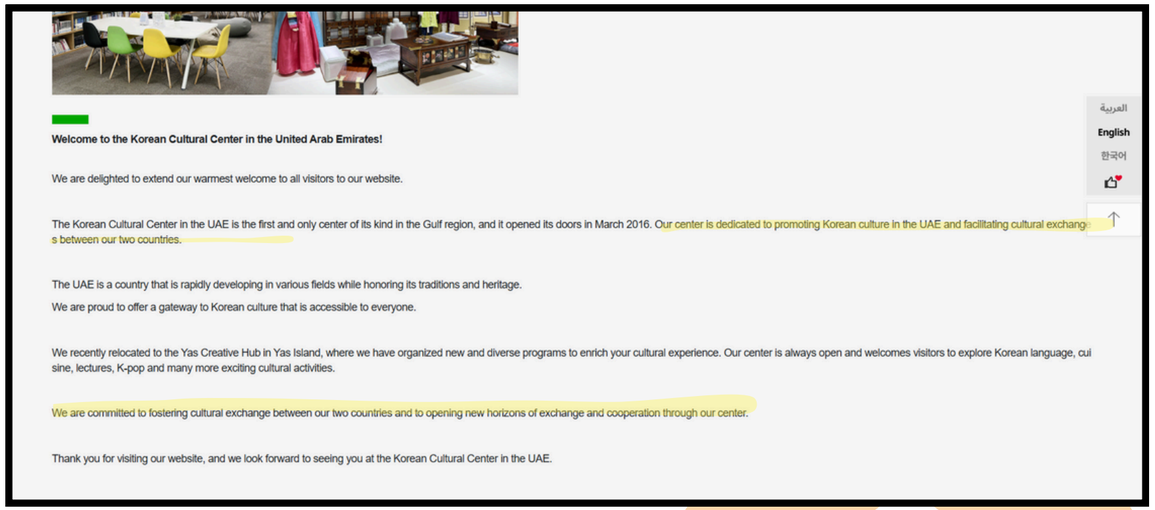
Over 175,000 employment are supported by Dubai's cultural and creative sectors, which generate over AED 21.9 billion in GDP yearly. (Dubai Culture & Arts Authority, 2023) .This demonstrates how cultural programs, such as Korean cultural efforts like KCC and JYP partnerships, directly assist a sector that is important to the country, enhancing its long-term sustainability value.

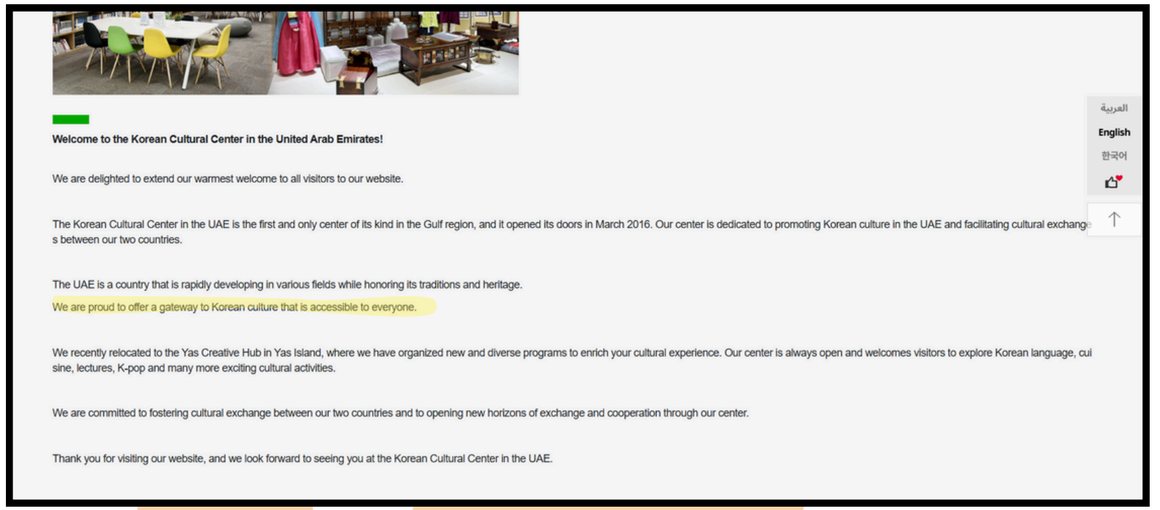
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- Korean Cultural Center UAE – Youth programs & cultural activities
- UAE Ministry of Culture & Youth – National cultural strategy & creative economy goals
- Khaleej Times (2024) – UAE's K-City cultural hub announcement
- FnNews (2025) – JYP ESG score (93.66) & sustainability ranking
- World Cities Culture Forum (2025) – Dubai creative economy data (GDP & jobs)
- Elkington (1997/1998) – Triple Bottom Line sustainability framework

Key Information gathered

(all URL in the reference page)





Public Claim 1: Inclusivity & Cultural Exchange

- Source: About Us Page of the Korean Cultural Centre UAE
- Highlighted statements are displayed in the screenshot:

- "Committed to advancing Korean culture in the United Arab Emirates."
- "Dedicated to promoting cultural interchange between our two nations."
- This validates KCC UAE's stated promises of cross-cultural understanding and long-term cultural growth.

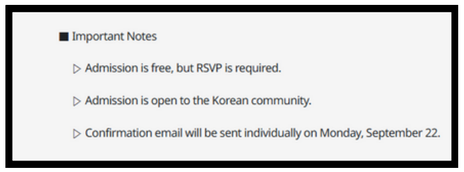
Public Claim 2: Everyone's Accessibility

- Source: Welcome/About Us Page of the Korean Cultural Centre UAE
- Highlighted text:

- "We take great pride in providing an accessible gateway to Korean culture."

- This validates the assertion of complete accessibility and unrestricted involvement.

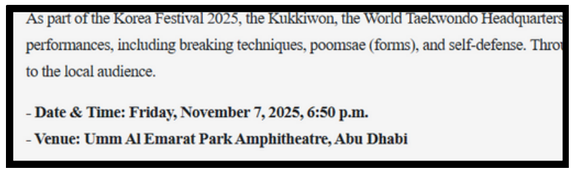
Key Information gathered

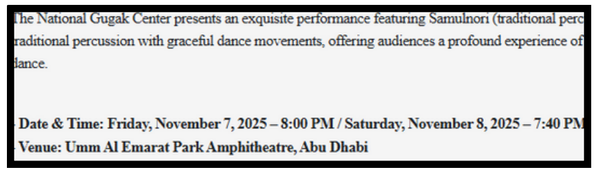


RSVP Requirement
Source: KCC UAE Event Notices
Screenshot highlights:

- "Admission is free, but RSVP is required."

Indicates access is restricted; contradicts claim of universal accessibility.





Source: Multiple event listings
Examples used:

- Korea Festival 2023 (Um Al Emarat Park Amphitheatre, Abu Dhabi)
- National Gugak Center UAE Performances (Abu Dhabi)

Shows concentrated programming in a single emirate rather than across the UAE.

Data and Sources (All links available in References)

- Korean Cultural Center UAE — Official Website (About Us, Events Page)

Primary source of public claims & program listings.

- Korean Cultural Center UAE — Events Archive (2023–2024)

Used to assess actual program patterns and access limitations.

- Gulf News (2024) – Traditional Korean Music Performance in UAE

Used to verify event types and promotional focus.

- BusinessNewse (2024) – Spread of Korean Culture in UAE

Used to confirm UAE-facing cultural expansion.

- UAE Ministry of Culture & Youth – Cultural Partnership Framework

Used to evaluate alignment with UAE cultural development goals.

Thank You